

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

WASHINGTON

August 6, 1943

In reply refer to
NE 862.4011/2280

My dear Rabbi Wise:

Mr. Richard Lichtheim and Mr. Gerhard Riegner have submitted, through the Legation at Bern, what they consider to be a correction of statements recently made in the press in this country to the effect that about four million European Jews are now under Axis domination, and they have requested that the following information be transmitted to you:

They believe that the number of Jews in continental Europe, excluding Russia, is between 1,500,000 and 2,000,000. They are distributed as follows:

Hungary and annexed territory.....	750,000
Rumania.....	250,000
France	100,000
Transnistria	60,000
Italy	50,000
Holland	50,000
Theresienstadt	45,000
Bulgaria	45,000
Belgium	25,000
Germany and Poland	A few hundred thousand,
	mostly in hiding or in labor camps.
Sweden, Spain, Switzerland and	
Portugal	50,000
Scattered in various countries	50,000

The number of victims has reached about 4,000,000.

Messrs. Lichtheim and Riegner have also requested that you be advised as follows:

"Anti-Jewish

Rabbi Stephen S. Wise, Ph.D.,
President, American Jewish Congress,
330 West Forty-second Street,
New York, New York.